Kelvin Creighton

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Education

University of Alberta **2026**

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science *Edmonton, AB*

- **Academic focus:** Cybersecurity
- **Relevant Courses:** Network Security, Cryptography, Software Engineering, Artificial Intelligence

Leadership Experience

Chapter Executive – OWASP **Jan 2026 – Present**

Open Worldwide Application Security Project (OWASP) — Edmonton Chapter *Edmonton, AB*

- Organized a Secure Coding Tournament for 50+ participants in partnership with Security Journey, guiding participants through identifying and patching vulnerabilities in intentionally flawed code.
- Coordinated a multi-organization cybersecurity training event with CMD+CTRL Security, bringing together OWASP Edmonton, WiCyS Edmonton, and C.H.A.D.S. for cyber-range experience.
- Supported delivery of CMD+CTRL's Dark Money cyber range, featuring 33 application-security challenges across XSS, SQLi, SSRF, access control, and business-logic flaws.

VP Events – C.H.A.D.S. **Sep 2024 – Sep 2026**

Cybersecurity, Hacking, And Digital Security club (CHADS) — University of Alberta *Edmonton, AB*

- Organized and supported over 5+ cybersecurity events consisting of competitions, technical talks, workshops, and community events throughout two academic years.
- Co-hosted 25+ challenges spanning web exploitation, cryptography, binary exploitation, forensics, and OSINT for C.H.A.D.S.'s annual Capture-the-Flag competition, contributing to growth from 30+ to over 200+ participants.
- Developed web exploitation CTF challenges involving SQL injection, IDOR, credential discovery, SSH key-based access, and unauthorized data retrieval, deploying them through CTFd on Linode with Docker-containerized environments.

Volunteering

WiCyS Cross Chapter CTF **Mar 2026**

Women in CyberSecurity (WiCyS) — Edmonton Chapter *Edmonton, AB*

- Developed 9 of 27 CTF challenges spanning web exploitation, binary exploitation, reverse engineering, and digital forensics.
- Configured CTFd infrastructure and Dockerized challenge environments to provide isolated, reproducible challenges for participants.
- Supported cross-chapter event planning, technical infrastructure, challenge testing, and competition logistics.

Work Experience

Technology Specialist Co-op **May 2024 – Sep 2024**

DiscoverE — University of Alberta *Edmonton, AB*

- Provided technical support across 20+ classrooms and office environments, troubleshooting hardware, software, and A/V issues on 20+ devices.
- Simplified an overengineered Apps Script employee sign-in/out system, reducing maintenance overhead.
- Engineered a full-stack inventory management system pairing a Google Sheets backend with an HTML5 front-end, with an Apps Script RBAC engine for cell-level permissions and row-verification logic reducing data concurrency errors.
- Identified a gap in the organization's data resilience and implemented secure on-premises backups of company Google Drive data to improve disaster recovery.

Achievements

National Cybersecurity Consortium (NCC) CTF | *Web Exploitation, LLM Prompt Injection* **Jun 2026**

- Placed 2nd nationally among university teams from across Canada in NCC's Capture the Flag competition.
- Exploited a leaking API endpoint to extract password hashes, cracking them to escalate access and retrieve the flag.
- Bypassed LLM-based identity verification by crafting a prompt injection that convinced the model to accept a fabricated user ID, escalating to unauthorized higher-privilege access.

Cisco Rapid Incident Response V7 | *XDR, EDR, SIEM* **Jul 2026**

- XDR incident-response workshop and lab covering investigation, threat hunting, attack-chain analysis, containment, and eradication.
- Used Cisco security tooling to correlate endpoint and email threat data, prioritize incidents by risk, and practice incident-response workflows.

CompTIA Security+ *(In Progress)* **August 2026 – Present**

Projects

MacSync Stealer — Static Malware Analysis | *Zsh, Bash, AppleScript, Static Analysis* **Dec 2025**

- Conducted static analysis of a ClickFix-style macOS infostealer campaign, decoding a base64-encoded, gzip-compressed multi-stage Zsh loader delivered via a disguised curl command.
- Identified stealth techniques including fileless execution and dynamic AppleScript-based C2 communication used for credential and browser-data theft.
- Traced exfiltration to a known IoC, confirming the sample as MacSync Stealer, and published a public write-up of the full attack chain.

Linux AI Homelab Cluster | *Debian, Linux, Docker, Networking, Tailscale* **May 2026 – Present**

- Built and maintained a multi-node Debian Linux cluster using repurposed hardware for agentic AI development and self-hosted workloads.
- Configured centralized SSH administration, Tailscale networking, iptables firewall policies, and automated SSHFS filesystem mounting across nodes.
- Containerized workloads with Docker and implemented inter-node network isolation, restricting communication to required management paths.

PicoCTF Writeups | *Burp Suite, Python, Flask, Jinja, MongoDB, NoSQL, XML, SOAP* **Oct 2025 – Dec 2025**

- Published technical writeups documenting exploitation of XXE, SSTI, NoSQL injection, and Python eval-based RCE vulnerabilities.
- Exploited XXE and SSTI vulnerabilities to read local files and achieve remote code execution through Jinja2 MRO/subclass traversal and subprocess.Popen.
- Bypassed Python eval blacklists and MongoDB authentication using payload obfuscation, dynamic imports, and NoSQL operators to retrieve flags.

JobPulse | *Python, PostgreSQL, OpenAI API*, Node.js **May 2026 – Present**

- Built a Node.js web scraper using Axios and Cheerio to aggregate listings from 4+ job boards with a high success rate.
- Integrated OpenAI API to score listings against user profiles, returning relevance scores, surfacing better-fit roles.

Skills

Cybersecurity: Web Exploitation, Vulnerability Analysis, Secure Coding, Static Malware Analysis, CTF Development, Incident Response, Threat Hunting, OSINT, LLM Security, Network Security, Application Security.

Security Tools: Burp Suite, Wireshark, Nmap, Hashcat, CTFd, Docker.

Programming: Python, C/C++, JavaScript, HTML, Bash, SQL, Zsh, AppleScript, Node.js.

Professional: Leadership, Communication, Event Organization, Documentation, Troubleshooting, Problem Solving, Cross-functional Collaboration.